what causes it (*see*: ***alambana***). *Sautrantikas* object to the ***Vaibhashika*** tenet that physical objects are built up out of partless atoms, that since the atoms have no parts (they would need boundaries if joined to others) they cannot combine to form larger whole things. Also, if the atoms are only manifested in this world for a very short time, it seems that by the time we perceive them they have gone.

See ***Dharmakirti***

Further reading: Matilal 1986; Mookerjee 1975

Savikalpaka-pratyaksha (concept-laden perception): Buddhists following ***Dignaga*** and ***Dharmakirti*** radically divorce sensory perception from the process of conceptualisation in which the mind not only organises but also adds to what has been given in perception. In response to this, realist philosophers insist that there are two varieties of perception: non-conceptual and non-linguistic sensory perception (***nirvikalpa-pratyaksha***) and perception that involves concepts (*savikalpaka-pratyaksha)*. In the second variety, concepts identify and structure the information received from perceptual sensation. Sensory impressions are themselves true to reality. Conceptual perception discriminates the object as an individual instance of a kind and discerns its various properties. The key point is that it operates on what has been given: the mind discovers, it does not invent features or impose anything on reality. Some ***Advaita-Vedantins***, following ***Mandana Mishra***, held that preconceptual perception reveals undifferentiated pure being. This stimulated the reaction that the primary perceptual stage receives unconceptualised information about the shared and specific features of its objects. What is distinctive about *savikalpaka-pratyaksha* is that it brings the object into sharper focus and compares it with other objects belonging to the same kind.

Further reading: Bartley 2002; Matilal 1986